

The History Department

YEAR 8 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 3 Curriculum Intent & Pedagogical Architecture

1. Curriculum Rationale & Local Maritime Heritage

Our Key Stage 3 history curriculum is intentionally constructed to link national and global historical narratives with the distinctive maritime geography and lived environment of The History Portal pupils. From the industrial revolution of the Fareham ironmaster (Henry Cort at Funtley) to the strategic supremacy of Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and the profound sacrifices recorded on the Stubbington village war memorials, history is made tangible, relevant, and deeply rooted in our coastal community.

2. Disciplinary Progression & Historical Enquiry

Across Years 7, 8, and 9, disciplinary thinking progresses sequentially to secure the foundational skills required for GCSE excellence:

- **Chronological Rigour & Global Encounters:** De-centering traditional anglocentric narratives by examining early global trade, Indigenous perspectives in Australia, and African resistance to the Transatlantic Slave Trade alongside British social transformations.
- **Causation & Consequence:** Moving from simple direct triggers in Year 7 to evaluating multi-tiered, long-term geopolitical catalysts (e.g. European alliance systems, naval arms races).
- **Source Utility & Forensic Evidence:** Progressing from basic comprehension to rigorous interrogation of provenance, evaluating authorial motive, audience, and historical reliability.
- **Historiographical Debate:** Engaging pupils with active academic debates (e.g., assessing the Magna Carta, or challenging the 'Lions led by Donkeys' narrative of the Great War) grounded in historical evidence.

3. Adaptive Teaching, Dual Coding & Inclusion

Pupils work through bespoke printed A4 workbooks closely paired with our digital learning portal. Standardized PEE/PEEL Structure Strips, Causal Connective Banks, consistent dual coding, and digital accessibility features offload working memory, ensuring all SEND and lower-attaining pupils achieve ambitious historical progress with zero cognitive overload.

KS3: Early Modern World & Global Encounters (1450–1750)

Year 8 | How 'global' was Britain's transformation between 1450 and 1750?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 Who held global power in 1450?	• Identify the major global powers and trading hubs in the year 1450. • Explain how the Ottoman Empire and West African kingdoms controlled global wealth. • Evaluate why Western Europe was on the periphery (edges) of world trade in 1450.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Detail from the Catalan Atlas (1375) showing Marco Polo's caravan on the Silk Road; Fresco of the Siege of Constantinople (1537); 16th-Century Benin Bronze Plaque  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate why Western Europe was on the periphery (edges) of world trade in 1450.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Explain why Europe was not the center of global wealth and power in 1450.
Lesson 2 How did religious conflict trigger global exploration (1517–1588)?	• Explain how the Protestant Reformation shattered European unity after 1517. • Analyze the role of Elizabethan privateers in challenging Catholic Spain's global monopoly. • Evaluate how the Spanish Armada (1588) marked a turning point in Britain's imperial ambitions.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Portrait of Gerardus Mercator (1574); Portrait of Martin Luther (1529); Map of the Treaty of Tordesillas (1494)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate how the Spanish Armada (1588) marked a turning point in Britain's imperial ambitions.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: How did the Protestant Reformation push England into global exploration and conflict with Spain?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 3 Trade or takeover: How did early encounters turn into empire?	- Explain how joint-stock corporations (like the East India Company and Virginia Company) funded early English expansion. - Compare the early English colonial encounters in North America (Roanoke and Jamestown) with mercantile trade in Mughal India. - Evaluate the turning point where peaceful commercial trade shifted into territorial takeover and subjugation.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Sir Thomas Roe at the Mughal Court (1615); View of the Thirteen Factories in Canton (c. 1800); Plan of James Fort in Virginia (1607)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the turning point where peaceful commercial trade shifted into territorial takeover and subjugation.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Explain how the creation of the East India Company (EIC) transformed British trade.
Lesson 4 James I and the Gunpowder Plot: Why was religious division so volatile?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Contemporary primary excerpts and archival evidence.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Significance - Evaluating the impact of the Renaissance on art and science. & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Newspaper Front Page
Lesson 5 Who controlled Britain? The Ideological Battle	- Analyze why Charles I and Parliament fought the English Civil War (1642–1651). - Evaluate how colonial wealth from sugar and tobacco reshaped British politics during the Commonwealth. - Debate who held true power in Britain by 1660: the Monarchy, Parliament, or Atlantic Capitalists.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: The East Offering its Riches to Britannia (1778)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate how colonial wealth from sugar and tobacco reshaped British politics during the Commonwealth.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: How did the English Civil War and the execution of Charles I change the balance of power?
Lesson 6 Who controlled Britain? The Economic Shift	- Analyze why Charles I and Parliament fought the English Civil War (1642–1651). - Evaluate how colonial wealth from sugar and tobacco reshaped British politics during the Commonwealth. - Debate who held true power in Britain by 1660: the Monarchy, Parliament, or Atlantic Capitalists.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: The East Offering its Riches to Britannia (1778); The Royal Exchange, London (1644); The Great Seal of the Commonwealth of England (1651)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Change and Continuity - Tracing the economic shift towards global trade. & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Explain how the 'Financial Revolution' (like the Bank of England) helped Britain build a modern empire.
Lesson 7 What were the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade?	- Understand the Triangular Trade and the middle passage. - Evaluate the economic legacy of slavery on Britain.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Contemporary primary excerpts and archival evidence.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the economic legacy of slavery on Britain.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: How did the Triangular Trade directly enrich British port cities?
Lesson 8 How did enslaved Africans resist the Transatlantic Slave Trade?	- Understand the different forms of covert and overt resistance. - Analyze primary sources from formerly enslaved Africans. - Investigate the Jamaican Maroon Wars.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Portrait of Olaudah Equiano (1789); Map of the Stono Rebellion route (1739); 18th-century botanical illustration of the Cassava root  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Causation - Why did the Witch Craze spread across early modern Europe? & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: Explain how the Jamaican Maroons successfully resisted British control.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 9 How 'modern' was Britain by 1750? (Synthesis & Assessment)	- Define what historians mean by a 'modern' state in the context of 18th-century Europe. - Synthesise domestic social realities with imperial/commercial expansion across the period 1450–1750. - Construct a high-level, structured final essay evaluating the extent of Britain's 'modernity' by 1750.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: The East Offering its Riches to Britannia (1778); The Royal Exchange, London (1644); John Rocque's Map of London (1746)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Construct a high-level, structured final essay evaluating the extent of Britain's 'modernity' by 1750.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: How 'modern' was Britain by 1750?

KS3: Industrialisation, Empire, and Power (1750–1900)

Year 8 | Industrialisation, Empire, and Power: How did 19th-century Britain transform at home and abroad?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 What powered the Industrial Revolution, and how did a Fareham ironmaster change the world?	- Explain how coal and Watt's steam engine replaced the domestic system and water power. - Analyse how Henry Cort's puddling and rolling processes at Funtley transformed brittle pig iron into tough naval wrought iron, evaluating surviving physical archaeology along the River Meon. - Evaluate the relative importance of Portsmouth Dockyard's location versus technological genius in Cort's success.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Coalbrookdale by Night (1801); Source B: Cort's Reverberatory Puddling Furnace (1783); Source C: Admiralty Navy Board Portsmouth Dockyard Trial Minutes (1787)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Analyse how Henry Cort's twin inventions at Funtley (puddling and rolling) solved the Royal Navy's pig iron crisis, and evaluate the surviving physical archaeology at the site.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent was the success of Henry Cort at Funtley Ironworks driven more by geographical proximity to Portsmouth Dockyard than by technological innovat..."
Lesson 2 Was industrial work progress or punishment?	- Explain how steam-powered factories replaced domestic handcraft with machine discipline and child exploitation. - Analyse how the Fareham Red Brick Boom connected local Hampshire clay pits to national imperial architecture like the Royal Albert Hall. - Evaluate whether the Industrial Revolution was primarily human punishment or societal progress using the Optimist vs. Pessimist debate.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Powerloom Weaving in 1835; Source B: The Royal Albert Hall, London (1871); Source C: Parliamentary Sadler Committee Report (1832)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the Optimist vs. Pessimist historical debate regarding whether industrial work represented societal progress or human punishment.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent was industrial work in 19th-century Britain an engine of human punishment rather than societal progress for the working classes?"
Lesson 3 Did industrialisation make British towns unlivable?	- Explain how rapid urbanisation, back-to-back housing, and cesspools created lethal conditions in industrial cities. - Analyse how King Cholera and the 1858 Great Stink shattered laissez-faire ideology, leading to Bazalgette's sewer network. - Evaluate the historical debate between Optimists and Pessimists regarding the living standards of the Victorian working class.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Gustave Doré, Over London by Rail (1872); Source B: John Leech, A Court for King Cholera (Punch, 1852); Source C: Edwin Chadwick, Report on the Sanitary Condition of the Labouring Population (1842)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate Edwin Chadwick's 1842 Sanitary Report and the 1875 Public Health Act using forensic archival evidence.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent did industrialisation make 19th-century British towns unlivable death traps for the working classes?"

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 4 How was the British Empire built and sustained?	- Explain how mercantilist trade networks and the East India Company extracted wealth and raw materials. - Analyse how Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and steam industrial technology sustained the Royal Navy's global supremacy. - Evaluate the impact of British imperial rule on colonized peoples, contrasting corporate profits with indigenous de-industrialisation.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Walter Crane, Imperial Federation Map of the World (1886); Source B: HMS Warrior at Portsmouth Royal Dockyard (1860); Source C: Robert Clive, Letter to the Court of Directors of the East India Company (1765)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the human and economic cost of British imperial rule on indigenous populations using archival dispatches.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent was the growth of the British Empire driven primarily by commercial technological enterprise rather than military and economic coercion?"
Lesson 5 How did the Empire strike back? The 1857 Indian Rebellion	- Explain the deep structural grievances (Doctrine of Lapse, taxation) and immediate spark (Enfield rifle) of the 1857 uprising. - Analyse the major turning points, including the capture of Delhi, the leadership of Rani Lakshmibai, and the brutality of reprisals. - Evaluate the historiographical debate between colonial British and modern Indian interpretations of the rebellion.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Map of British Annexations under the Doctrine of Lapse (1848–1856); Source B: Lithograph of Rani Lakshmibai of Jhansi Leading Cavalry (1858); Source C: The Azamgarh Proclamation (25 August 1857)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Analyse how the rebellion spread and evaluate the symbolic leadership of figures like Rani Lakshmibai of Jhansi and Emperor Bahadur Shah Zafar.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent should the 1857 Indian Rebellion be characterized as a reactionary military mutiny rather than a widespread war for national liberation?"
Lesson 6 How did ordinary people fight for a voice?	- Explain the causes and violent aftermath of the 1819 Peterloo Massacre and the repressive Six Acts. - Analyse the Hampshire Swing Riots of 1830 and the legal trial of the 1834 Tolpuddle Martyrs. - Evaluate the methods and historical legacy of the Chartist movement between 1838 and 1848.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: George Cruikshank, The Massacre of Peterloo (1819); Source B: The Threat of Captain Swing (Hampshire, October 1830); Source C: George Loveless, Statement upon Sentencing at Dorchester Assizes (March 1834)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the strategic split within Chartism between Moral Force and Physical Force using primary source manifestos.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent did working-class popular protests between 1819 and 1848 achieve their goals of securing political and economic rights?"
Lesson 7 How did the road to democracy expand?	- Explain the corruption of the unreformed electoral system (Rotten Boroughs, pocket boroughs, open hustings). - Analyse the 1832 Great Reform Act as a tactical compromise between aristocrats and the middle class. - Evaluate how the 1872 Secret Ballot Act and the 1867/1884 Reform Acts laid the foundations for mass democracy.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Parliamentary Representation Map of England & Wales & Unreformed Boroughs (1832); Source B: The Reform Tree (Satirical Engraving on the 1832 Reform Act); Source C: Minutes of Evidence taken before the Select Committee on Corrupt Practices (1869)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the transformative impact of the 1872 Secret Ballot Act and franchise expansions (1867 & 1884) on working-class political power.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Enquiry Essay: "To what extent was the expansion of British democracy between 1832 and 1884 granted as a tactical concession by ruling elites rather than won by popular war..."

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 8 Who truly benefited from 19th-century transformation?	- Analyse the "Optimist" argument using quantitative data on wages, public health, and technological innovation. - Analyse the "Pessimist" argument regarding working-class slum squalor, alienation, and colonial economic extraction. - Synthesize competing historiographical interpretations into a rigorous, balanced capstone enquiry essay.	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Historical Data on Real Wages & Consumption in Britain (1815–1880); Source B: Friedrich Engels, <i>The Condition of the Working Class in England</i> (1845); Source C: Dadabhai Naoroji, <i>Poverty and Un-British Rule in India</i> (1901)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the "Optimist" interpretation that industrialisation created unprecedented civilizational wealth and higher living standards.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Capstone Enquiry Essay: "Who truly benefited from nineteenth-century industrial and imperial transformation: the British ruling elite, the British working class, or the sub..."

Unit Key Vocabulary: Industrial Revolution • Industrialisation • Domestic System • Factory System • Puddling Process • Wrought Iron • Steam Power • Urbanisation • Slum • Back-to-Back Housing • Public Health • Cholera • Miasma Theory • Laissez-faire • Child Labour • Factory Acts • Trade Union • Captain Swing • Swing Riots • Chartism • People's Charter • Universal Suffrage • Franchise • Rotten Borough • Pocket Borough • Great Reform Act (1832) • Secret Ballot Act (1872) • Empire • Colonialism • Imperialism • East India Company • Sepoy • Indian Rebellion (1857) • British Raj • Ironclad • Two-Power Standard • Historiography • Optimist View • Pessimist View • Synthesis

KS3: History of Australia

Year 8 | Invasion, Settlement, or Survival? How should we remember the colonization of Australia?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 Claiming Australia	- Describe how and why the British Empire claimed Australia, including Captain Cook's voyage and the concept of terra nullius - Explain the significance of colonisation for both the British Empire and the Indigenous Australian peoples - Evaluate whether the British arrival should be understood as discovery, settlement, or invasion	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: Secret Instructions to Captain Cook; Source B: A Portrait of Captain James Cook; Source C: Initial Encounter at Botany Bay  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Explain the dual purpose of James Cook's voyage, contrasting the public scientific mission with the secret government orders to claim territory.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 2 Creating a Convict Colony	- Describe the key features of the convict transportation system and explain why Britain used Australia as a penal colony - Explain how the British Empire used convict labour to establish a colonial foothold in the Pacific - Evaluate the human cost of the convict system and its role in the revolution of Australian settlement	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Prison Hulks in Portsmouth Harbour  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Analyse the work and social conditions of the convicts, contrasting general labor with the punishments of the chain road gangs.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 3 Encounters with the Indigenous Peoples	- Describe the impact of British colonisation on Indigenous Australian communities, including the destruction of trade, culture, and land - Explain how Indigenous Australians showed resistance to British settlement through both armed conflict and cultural survival - Evaluate the significance of these encounters for understanding the long-term consequences of empire	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Bennelong's Letter to England; Early Settlement at Sydney Cove  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 4 From Penal Colony to Settlement	- Describe how Australia transitioned from a penal colony to a free settlement through migration and the Gold Rush - Explain how empire, revolution, and change shaped the development of Australian society in the 19th century - Evaluate who benefited most from Australia's transformation and who was marginalised	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: William Barak's Testimony; The Australian Gold Rush  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 5 Lesson 5: Assessment - What's the story of Australia?	- Synthesise knowledge of colonisation, empire, resistance, and change across the history of Australia - Construct a sustained argument evaluating whose perspective should shape how we remember Australia's history - Deploy specific evidence to support a judgement about the legacy of empire in Australia	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Contemporary primary excerpts and archival evidence.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the usefulness of primary sources for historical enquiries.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Write a narrative account analyzing the development of Australia between the years 1788 and 1855.

Unit Key Vocabulary: Ancestors • Botany Bay • Colony • Gweagal • Navigator • Royal Society • Terra Nullius • First Fleet • Convict • Governor • Hard labour • Hulk • Transportation • Sydney Cove • Eora • Frontier • Guerrilla Warfare • Dispossession • Massacre • Squatter • Merino • Gold Rush • Immigrant • Xenophobia • White Australia Policy